

Copper

29
Cu

This distinctly red metal is one of the few metallic elements to be found pure in nature. It was one of the first metals to be used by humans. Mixing it with tin forms a tough alloy called bronze, which has been in use for more than 5,000 years.

Pellets of pure copper refined in a laboratory



ATOMIC MASS 63.546

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY Prehistoric

Zinc

30
Zn



Although this element was not recognized until the 18th century, compounds of zinc have been in use for many centuries. Calamine lotion, for example, contains zinc oxide and is an ancient recipe for soothing itches.

ATOMIC MASS 65.38

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1746
(Andreas Marggraf)

**Laboratory sample
of pure zinc**